

An Act

ENROLLED SENATE
BILL NO. 1531

By: Haste of the Senate

and

Miller and Hill of the
House

An Act relating to aerospace, aircraft, and aviation infrastructure; amending 3 O.S. 2021, Section 421, as last amended by Section 3, Chapter 237, O.S.L. 2025 (3 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 421), which relates to the clearinghouse for unmanned aircraft systems; authorizing the Oklahoma Department of Aerospace and Aeronautics to take certain actions; providing for the promulgation of rules; and providing an effective date.

SUBJECT: Aerospace infrastructure

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 3 O.S. 2021, Section 421, as last amended by Section 3, Chapter 237, O.S.L. 2025 (3 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 421), is amended to read as follows:

Section 421. A. The Oklahoma Department of Aerospace and Aeronautics is hereby established as the clearinghouse for unmanned aircraft systems (UAS) and advanced air mobility (AAM) in this state and shall be designated as the agency of this state for the promotion, enhancement, and development of UAS and AAM as well as any associated infrastructure necessary to ensure the safe integration and use of this new technology within the state. The purpose of this clearinghouse is to create a partnership between those entities that currently operate UAS, those that desire to use this technology in the future, and other entities that can support the research and development of UAS to ensure that this state can more effectively respond to the needs of this critical sector of the

aviation and aerospace industry. In the operation of this clearinghouse, the Department shall cooperate, assist, and coordinate with the federal government, agencies of this state, tribal entities, municipalities, and other persons in the development of unmanned aircraft systems throughout the state to ensure the acceptance of this technology and the successful integration of UAS into the National Airspace System. Contingent upon the availability of funds, the Oklahoma Department of Aerospace and Aeronautics may use established program processes or may contract with other qualified entities to carry out the duties and responsibilities of the Unmanned Aircraft Systems Development Act of 2021.

B. The primary goal of the clearinghouse within the Department is to establish a central point within state government to develop and implement the strategy for how this state can become a leader in the UAS and AAM industry. It will focus the collective resources, knowledge, information, and assets within state government to ensure coordinated efforts amongst all parties. The clearinghouse will have the authority to:

1. Conduct research on what other states and localities are doing insofar as their UAS rules and regulations so that it can provide recommendations to ensure this state is in the best position within the industry;

2. Organize and coordinate the application for any UAS and AAM test site, integration opportunity, pilot program, or grant funding on behalf of this state;

3. Maintain a registry of UAS being operated by state agencies, except those UAS that are part of a university-affiliated research program;

4. Maintain a registry of educational institutions that offer training programs for users of UAS;

5. Investigate the development of, and if necessary, create a statewide system plan that will provide the framework for the construction, development, siting, and potential partnerships required for vertiports and other infrastructure needed to integrate

AAM and UAS into the existing air transportation system of the state;

6. Develop a statewide network of UAS and AAM detection systems as necessary to support the safe integration of these technologies into the state's existing air transportation system; ~~and~~

7. Create statewide or regional command, control, and radar systems or centers to carry out the provisions of paragraph 6 of this subsection and the Department's efforts to bring UAS and AAM testing and development to the state. These systems or centers can be stand-alone or in partnership with other federal, state, local, tribal, or non-profit entities;

8. Invest in publicly owned infrastructure to support the mission of the clearinghouse and the provisions of this section; and

9. Partner and collaborate with other states and industry stakeholders as necessary to create regional or technical centers of excellence with an interest in integration for UAS and AAM technologies.

C. The Department is authorized to enter into partnerships with any city or town of this state and any county or political subdivision or district in this state, or any public trust thereof, or any federal government entity for the purpose of investing in and operating infrastructure and any other items necessary to safely and effectively integrate AAM and UAS into the existing air transportation system of this state as well as the testing and development of these aeronautical technologies.

D. The Department is authorized to promulgate any rules necessary to implement the provisions of the Unmanned Aircraft Systems Development Act of 2021.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

Passed the Senate the 14th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the 29th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____